in moralistic terms when in reality India was building its military potential[15] – something Kautilya would have advised. Rashed further argues that even after the end of the cold war India still follows Kautilya in being 'wary of depending on one group of allies'. [16] Despite close relations with Western countries, India still maintains ties with Russia, old friends in the developing world from the Non-Aligned Movement and is an active participant in the BRICS organization. The layered alliances and the mistrust of all allies reflects an embrace of the mandala theory.

Like Rashed, Liebig too argues that non-alignment is simply Kautilyan realism adapted to the modern world. Liebig asserts that not only did Nehru read the *Arthashastra* but also mentioned it in numerous writings and even wrote an article under the pseudonym 'Chanakya.'[17] Liebig sees Kautilyan influence in everyday Indian life. To him the naming of the diplomatic enclave as Chanakyapuri and of a street in Delhi called Kautilya Marg (Kautilya Road) represent this influence. Liebig sees great significance in television serials about Chanakya or about the Mauryas. He observes that Chanakya's portrait hangs prominently on the walls in departments of political science at various Indian universities.

Some of these arguments, however, seem facile. Television serials on, say, Henry VIII and his wives in Britain reflect entertainment value and interest in the life of the monarch, not his philosophical influence on current British foreign policy. Moreover, political science departments in European universities might display portraits of Machiavelli, Thucydides or Morgenthau even when their professors and students embrace views critical of these realists. Not only does New Delhi have a Kautilya Marg, it also names its streets after other historic figures and foreign dignitaries. Even the Mughal emperor, Aurangzeb, who is seldom admired by Hindus or tolerant Indian Muslims, till recently, had a street named after him. The main road in almost every Indian city is named after Mahatma Gandhi but